Exp 11: Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

1. Aim

To deploy the Gym Membership Management application from the development environment of Zoho Creator to the production environment, by preparing a publish with its title, type and notification email, publishing it to the Stage environment, and confirming from the notification email that the version was published to Production.

2. Procedure

2.1 Deployment Requirements

An application that is still being built must not be changed while end users are working in it. Creator therefore keeps separate environments, and a version is moved from one to the next in a controlled publish. Four steps were carried out, as listed in Table 1.

Step	Component	Details
Prepare the publish	Publish form	Title, description, type (Major or Minor) and email notification address
Check the version	Application versions list	Gym Membership Management, Build 1.0.0
Move the version forward	Publish to Stage	Publish process started and tracked on the Environments page
Confirm the deployment	Email notification	Message that the version was successfully published to Production

Table 1: Deployment steps and the components used

2.2 Environments in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator provides three environments for an application. Table 2 shows the purpose of each. The application is built and changed in Development, checked in Stage by testers, and released to the end users from Production. Because the end users work only in Production, a change made in Development does not affect them until it is published.

Environment	Purpose
Development	The builder works here; forms, reports and scripts are created and changed
Stage	A copy used for testing the version before the release
Production	The live copy that the end users use

Table 2: Environments and their purpose

2.3 Preparing the Publish

The publish was started from the Environments section, where the version to be moved is chosen. The publish form (Figure 1) asks for the following:

- **Title:** the name of the package that is published; here “Gym entry and exit form new”.
- **Description:** an optional note of up to 500 characters about what the version contains. It was left empty.
- **Type:** *Major* marks the main application, whereas *Minor* marks an extension to a Major application. Major was selected because this is the main application.
- **Email Notification:** the address that receives a message when the publish is finished.

The right side of the form lists the application versions that will be published. It shows Gym Membership Management with Build 1.0.0. A notice on the page reminds the user that the application is not available to the

end users while it is being published, so it should be pushed to a different environment in the meantime. After the details were checked, the **Publish** button was clicked.

2.4 Publishing to the Stage Environment

Creator confirmed the request with the message “Publish to Stage initiated” (Figure 2). The publish takes a few minutes, its status can be followed on the Environments page through the **Go to Environments** button, and an email is sent once the process has finished. The version was therefore not copied at once, but queued and completed in the background, so the person who started it can carry on with other work.

2.5 Confirming the Deployment to Production

When the process finished, the notification email arrived from the Zoho Creator Team (Figure 3). It states that the following version has been successfully published to Production, and it lists the title Gym Membership Management with the current version Gym Membership Management - 2.0. The email also gives the address that initiated the publish and the date and time, 11 Oct 2026 at 19:50 IST, which makes it a record of who deployed the application and when. The Go to Environments link in the email opens the Environments page for more details.

2.6 Testing the Deployment

The deployment was checked through the Environments page and the notification email. Table 3 lists the cases covered and the behaviour that is expected.

Test case	Action	Expected behaviour
Publish request	Fill in the publish form and click Publish	Message “Publish to Stage initiated” appears (Figure 2)
Status tracking	Open Go to Environments	The progress of the publish is shown on the Environments page
Notification	Wait for the publish to finish	Email says the version was successfully published to Production (Figure 3)
Version check	Read the email	The current version of Gym Membership Management is listed as 2.0

Table 3: Test cases for the deployment

3. Output

The following figures show the publish form, the confirmation that the publish started, and the email received after the deployment.

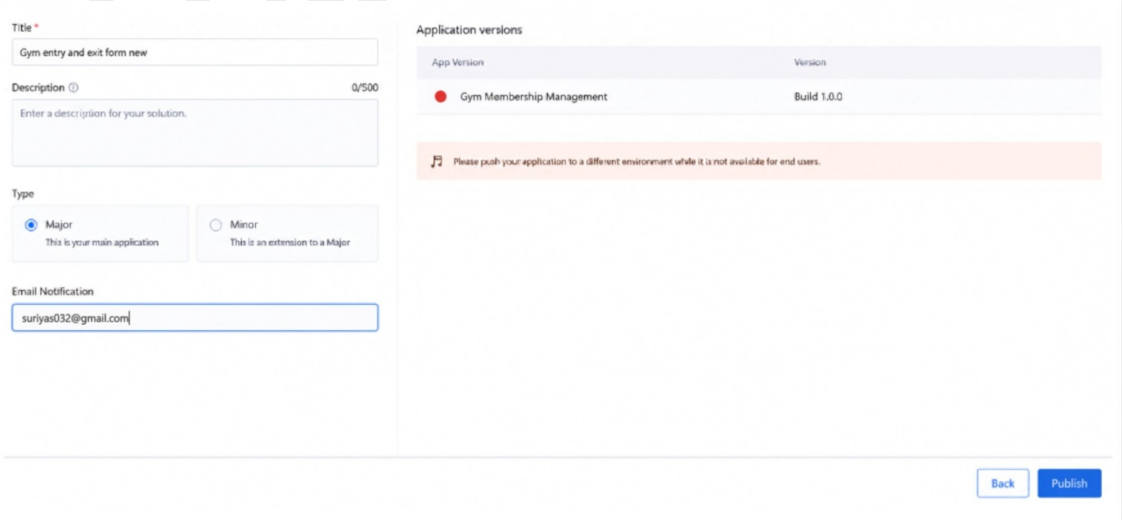


Figure 1: Publish form with title, type (Major), email notification and the application version Build 1.0.0

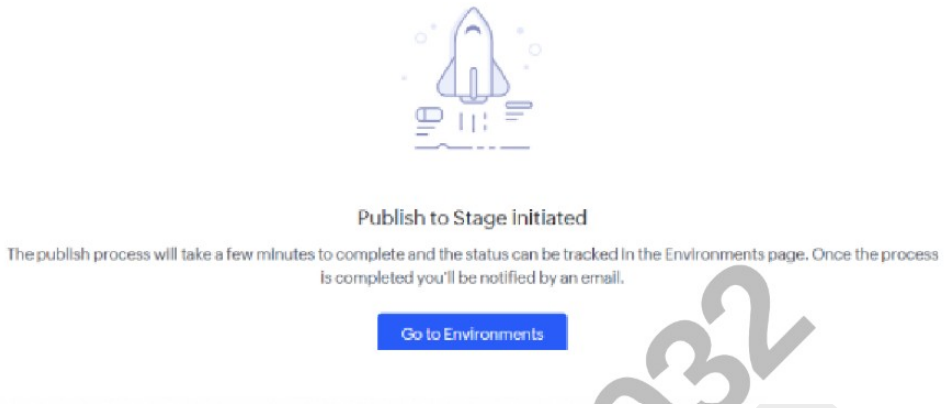


Figure 2: "Publish to Stage initiated" confirmation with the Go to Environments button

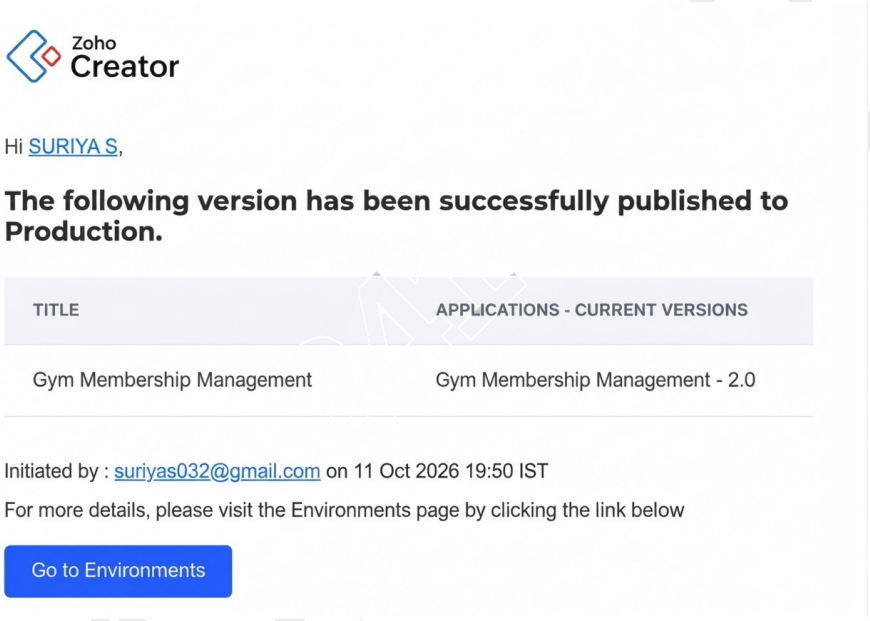


Figure 3: Email "The following version has been successfully published to Production"

Observations from the output

- The publish runs in the background and is tracked on the Environments page, so the builder is not blocked while the version is being moved.
- Development, Stage and Production are kept apart, so changes can be tested before the end users see them.
- The notification email names the application, its current version, the person who started the publish and the time, which gives a simple record of the deployment.
- Choosing the type Major for the main application and Minor for an extension keeps the versions of a larger solution organised.

4. Result

The Gym Membership Management application was deployed in Zoho Creator from the development environment towards production. The publish form was completed, the publish to Stage was started and tracked, and the notification email confirmed that the version was successfully published to Production. This completes the deployment requirements of this experiment.